

UNNATURAL DEATH REPORT -- FIRST INFORMATION

Section 174 CrPC -- registered at Turahalli PS, 14-10-2018, 08:55 hrs

UDR No.	0412/2018
Date and time of information	14-10-2018, 08:55 hrs
Informant	Sri Deepak Menon, aged 34, of Uttarahalli; jogger (statement at page 3)
Place of occurrence	Turahalli Minor Forest, upper trail, base of "Sunset Rock" (approx. 1.4 km from the Kanakapura Road gate)
Date and time of occurrence	14-10-2018, between 06:30 and 07:40 hrs (approx.)
Nature	Fall from height while trekking alone -- accidental (provisional)
Investigating officer	SI R. Prabhakar
Supervising officer	Inspector B. R. Shivakumar

Particulars of the deceased

Full name	RAVI SHARMA
Father's name	Late Gopal Sharma
Date of birth / age	17-08-1957 / 61 years
Sex	Male
Occupation	Retired engineer (BEML, 2016)
Residence	No. 42, 8th Cross, Malleshwaram, Bengaluru 560003
Mobile	98450 22417
Identification	Spectacles; short grey beard; scar on left knee. Identified by daughter from the wallet and person.
Next of kin	Smt. Lakshmi Sharma (wife, 58), same address
Children	Kum. Meera Sharma (daughter, 20), unmarried, r/o Koramangala, Bengaluru
Informed	Wife by phone 09:30 hrs; daughter reached the scene 10:20 hrs



photo supplied by family

Brief facts

At about 08:40 hrs the informant and another jogger (Smt. S. Iyer) found a male person lying at the base of the rock outcrop known locally as Sunset Rock, on the upper trail of Turahalli Minor Forest, not moving. They informed the forest gate guard, who informed this station. The deceased was identified from the wallet as Ravi Sharma. He was known to the gate staff as a regular solo walker on Sunday mornings; his vehicle, white Maruti Dzire KA-03-MH-2214, was parked at the gate.

The deceased appears to have climbed to the ledge on top of the rock (approx. 12 m) as was his habit, and fallen from it. The body was moved to Victoria General Hospital for post-mortem. The wife was informed at 09:30 hrs and the daughter, Kum. Meera Sharma, reached the gate at 10:20 hrs and identified the deceased.

The gate register for the morning is annexed (page 3). The deceased's personal effects were recovered from the scene and are listed at page 2.

R. PrabhakarR. Prabhakar -- Sub-Inspector, Turahalli PS
14-10-2018**RECEIVED**

SCENE OF OCCURRENCE -- INSPECTION REPORT

inspected 14-10-2018, 09:40 to 11:10 hrs, by SI R. Prabhakar with scene photographer HC 2210

Sunset Rock is a granite outcrop on the upper trail with a flat ledge on top reached by a scramble on the north side. The ledge is about 12 m above the trail on the south side, where the deceased was found. The ledge showed moss scuffed at the southern lip over about half a metre. The deceased's steel water bottle was standing upright on the ledge near the scramble, about 3 m from the lip. No slip marks were found on the scramble. Light rain had fallen the previous night.

Effects recovered from the deceased and from the ground within 3 m of the body, and handed to the family against receipt: leather wallet with Rs 640 and cards; mobile phone (screen cracked); key ring with three keys; steel water bottle (from the ledge); one blue aluminium carabiner clip with a small cloth tag marked "TD 2018", found on the trail 2 m from the body.

Nothing further was found at the scene. There was no sign of any other person at the ledge at the time of inspection.



14-10-2018 TURAHALLI PS EXHIBIT 1 UDR 0412/2018
Exhibit 1. Sunset Rock from the trail below. The ledge at top right; the deceased was found at the base, left of centre.



14-10-2018 TURAHALLI PS EXHIBIT 2 UDR 0412/2018
Exhibit 2. The ledge on top of the rock. Moss scuffed at the lip (foreground). Water bottle of the deceased standing near the scramble.



14-10-2018 TURAHALLI PS EXHIBIT 3 UDR 0412/2018
Exhibit 3. Base of the rock, trail side, taped off. Position of the body marked. Trail continues to the left towards the gate.



14-10-2018 TURAHALLI PS EXHIBIT 4 UDR 0412/2018
Exhibit 4. Effects as recovered: wallet, phone, keys, water bottle, and the carabiner clip with tag "TD 2018" found on the trail.

FOREST GATE REGISTER -- EXTRACT

Kanakapura Road gate, 14-10-2018 -- copied from the guard's register by SI R. Prabhakar

Time in	Vehicle / person	Purpose	Time out	Guard's remark
05:50	Walkers (2), on foot	morning walk	07:05	
06:05	Two-wheeler, black, KA-05 .. 7 (rest not noted)	trek	07:35	young man, rucksack, spectacles; said he is meeting a family friend up the trail. Left fast.
06:20	Car, white, KA-03-MH-2214 (Sharma sir)	walk -- regular, Sundays	--	did not come out
06:45	Jogger (D. Menon)	jog	09:20	reported the fall
06:50	Jogger (S. Iyer)	jog	09:25	reported the fall

STATEMENT -- Sri Nanjappa, gate guard (aged 58)

recorded 14-10-2018, 12:10 hrs

I have been on the Kanakapura Road gate for nine years. Sharma sir comes every Sunday at about six-twenty and walks up to the big rock and comes back by eight. He always comes alone. On the 14th he came at the usual time. Before him, at about five past six, a young man came on a black scooter with a rucksack. He had spectacles. I asked his purpose and he said he was going up the trail to meet a family friend. I wrote "trek". He came out at about twenty-five to eight, walking fast, and went off on the scooter. I did not see Sharma sir come out. At about quarter to nine the joggers came running down and said a man had fallen at the rock.

STATEMENT -- Smt. S. Iyer, jogger (aged 41)

recorded 14-10-2018, 12:40 hrs

I run the upper trail on Sunday mornings. At about ten past seven I was passing below the big rock and I heard two men's voices above me, on the rock, arguing. One voice was older and one was younger. The older voice said loudly, "stay away from her." I did not look up and I did not see them; the rock is high. I continued my run. On the way back at about twenty to nine my friend Deepak and I found the man lying at the base of the rock and we ran to the gate.

Q. Did you see anyone else on the trail? A. Some time after the voices a young man ran past me going down, fast. I did not see his face. I thought he had fallen and hurt his hand.

R. Prabhakar

R. Prabhakar -- SI
14-10-2018



14-10-2018 EXHIBIT 5 UDR 0412/2018

Exhibit 5. Kanakapura Road gate and guard hut, 14-10-2018, 09:15 hrs. The register is kept on the desk inside. The deceased's car is parked beyond the barrier.

POST-MORTEM EXAMINATION -- EXTRACT OF FINDINGS

Deceased	Ravi Sharma, M, 61 yrs, S/o late Gopal Sharma, r/o Malleshwaram
Brought by	PC 4471, Turahalli PS
Identified by	Kum. Meera Sharma (daughter) and Smt. Lakshmi Sharma (wife)
Examined	15-10-2018, 10:30 hrs
Examiner	Dr. S. Hegde, Asst. Professor

External injuries

Fracture-dislocation of the cervical spine; depressed fracture of the right parietal bone; multiple abrasions over the back and right side of the trunk consistent with impact on rock.

Abrasions over the knuckles of the right hand. Left index fingernail torn to the bed. Consistent with the hand striking or grasping rock during the fall.

Oval contusion, 3 x 2 cm, over the lateral aspect of the left upper arm, with three smaller contusions in a line proximal to it. Noted. Attributed to impact.

Internal / chemical

Blood alcohol: nil. No natural disease found sufficient to cause death.

Opinion

Death is due to head and spinal injuries consequent to a fall from height. Time since death at examination is consistent with death between 06:30 and 07:45 hrs on 14-10-2018.

Dr. S. Hegde

Dr. S. Hegde -- Forensic Medicine
15-10-2018

MOBILE PHONE OF THE DECEASED -- NOTE BY IO

examined 15-10-2018 before return to the family

The handset (screen cracked, working) was examined for the last activity. Last outgoing call: 13-10-2018, 20:05 hrs, to "Meera" (daughter). Last incoming call: 14-10-2018, 05:48 hrs, duration 1 min 40 s, from a contact saved as "R (Meera's friend)" -- a family friend, since informed of the death. No message activity on the morning of 14-10-2018. The handset was returned to the family with the effects. No further examination was considered necessary.

CLOSURE REPORT

Unnatural Death Report -- Sec. 174 CrPC

1. Summary of enquiry

The deceased, Ravi Sharma (61), a retired engineer, was in the habit of walking alone in Turahalli Minor Forest every Sunday morning and climbing to the ledge of Sunset Rock. On 14-10-2018 he entered the forest by car at 06:20 hrs and was found at the base of the rock at about 08:40 hrs by two joggers. The scene inspection, the gate register and the statements of the gate guard and the joggers were recorded. The post-mortem attributes death to head and spinal injuries from a fall from height. No alcohol was detected.

2. Findings

The ledge is unfenced and the lip was wet and mossy after rain in the night. The deceased, aged 61, appears to have slipped or lost his footing at the lip and fallen to the trail below. No suicide note was found and the family reports no such intention. There is no evidence of foul play.

The effects recovered, including a carabiner clip found on the trail, were returned to the family. The other visitors recorded at the gate that morning were not traced and their evidence was not considered necessary to the enquiry.

3. Conclusion

From the enquiry, the death of Ravi Sharma is found to be accidental, caused by a fall from the rock while walking alone in the forest. No cognizable offence is made out. The UDR is closed. The Forest Department is advised to fence the ledge of Sunset Rock.

CLOSED -- ACCIDENTAL DEATHR. PrabhakarR. Prabhakar -- Sub-Inspector
06-11-2018B. R. ShivakumarB. R. Shivakumar -- Inspector
06-11-2018

Copy issued to Smt. Lakshmi Sharma (wife) and Kum. Meera Sharma (daughter) on request, 19-10-2018, and closure page on 08-11-2018. Effects (page 2) handed over to the daughter against receipt, 19-10-2018. -- Station Writer